

Causative: have/get something done

CEFR B2

Lesson Pack · summary, worksheet & answer key

Quick answer

The causative says someone else does a job for you. Use have/get + object + past participle:

- 1 Arranging a service — I had my car repaired (someone repaired it for me).
- 2 'Get' for an informal tone — I got my hair cut.
- 3 Something that happens to you — They had their car towed.

Put the tense on 'have/get', keep the past participle fixed. Don't confuse 'I had my car repaired' (someone did it) with 'I repaired my car' (I did it).

At a glance

Meaning	Structure	Example
Arrange a service	have + object + participle	I had my car repaired .
Same, more informal	get + object + participle	I got my hair cut .
Change the tense on have/get	(tense) have/get + object + participle	She has had her photo taken .
Something happens to you	have + object + participle	They had their flight cancelled .

Learning objectives

- Can form the causative with have/get + object + past participle (CEFR B2).
- Can change the tense on have/get while keeping the participle.
- Can distinguish 'have something done' from doing it yourself.



Practice worksheet

Circle the correct option. Causative: have/get something done · CEFR B2

Name: _____

Date: _____

1. I don't repair cars myself. I ____ .

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|-------------------------|-------------------------|
| A. have my car repaired | B. have repaired my car |
| C. have my car repair | D. repair my car |

2. She ____ last week — it looks great and short now.

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|---------------------|---------------------|
| A. cut her hair | B. had her hair cut |
| C. had cut her hair | D. has her hair cut |

3. We're ____ next week — the walls are looking tired.

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|-----------------------------|-----------------------------|
| A. having the house painted | B. painting had the house |
| C. have the house paint | D. having painted the house |

4. Choose the informal version of 'I had my phone fixed.'

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|--------------------------|------------------------|
| A. I got my phone fixed. | B. I get fix my phone. |
| C. I had fixed my phone. | D. I fixed my phone. |

5. They ____ at the airport — someone took it from the carousel.

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|-------------------------|-------------------------|
| A. had their bag stolen | B. stole their bag |
| C. had stolen their bag | D. have their bag steal |

6. I need to ____ before my trip.

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|----------------------------|--------------------------|
| A. get my passport renewed | B. get renew my passport |
| C. renew got my passport | D. get my passport renew |

7. Correct this: 'He had his tooth remove yesterday.'

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| A. He had his tooth removed yesterday. | B. He had removed his tooth yesterday. |
| C. He has his tooth remove yesterday. | D. The sentence is already correct. |

8. What does 'I had my windows cleaned' mean?

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| A. Someone cleaned the windows for me. | B. I cleaned the windows myself. |
| C. I will clean the windows. | D. My windows clean themselves. |

9. Put the tense correctly: 'She ____ her eyes tested every year.'

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|-------------|------------|
| A. has | B. having |
| C. had been | D. is have |

10. Which sentence means you did the work YOURSELF?

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|-----------------------------|----------------------------------|
| A. I painted the fence. | B. I had the fence painted. |
| C. I got the fence painted. | D. I'm having the fence painted. |

Answer key

Correct answers with explanations · for the teacher

1. **A. have my car repaired** — Causative = have + object + participle: 'have my car repaired'.
2. **B. had her hair cut** — A hairdresser did it: 'She had her hair cut'.
3. **A. having the house painted** — Continuous causative: 'having the house painted'.
4. **A. I got my phone fixed.** — 'Get' is the informal equivalent: 'I got my phone fixed'.
5. **A. had their bag stolen** — Something happened to them: 'had their bag stolen'.
6. **A. get my passport renewed** — Causative with 'get': 'get my passport renewed'.
7. **A. He had his tooth removed yesterday.** — Use the past participle: 'had his tooth removed'.
8. **A. Someone cleaned the windows for me.** — The causative means someone did it for you.
9. **A. has** — A yearly habit takes the present: 'She has her eyes tested every year'.
10. **A. I painted the fence.** — 'I painted the fence' — you did it.